

Global View - 死刑 (C0144)

Global View - Capital Punishment (C0144)

对话 / Dialogue

Professor That's all for today's class. We will continue our lecture on crime and punishment tomorrow.

今天的课就到这里。我们明天继续讲关于犯罪与刑罚的内容。

A Do you think we should be tougher on crime?
你觉得我们应该对犯罪更强硬吗？

B Well, it depends on what you mean.
嗯，这要看你指的是什么。

A For example, we could bring back the death penalty for murder, give longer prison sentences for lesser offences and lock up juvenile offenders.
比如说，我们可以恢复对谋杀判处死刑，对较轻的罪行处以更长的刑期，还有把少年犯关起来。

B Those really sound like Draconian measures. Firstly, what do you do about miscarriages of justice if you've already put innocent people to death?
这些听起来真像是严酷的措施。首先，如果你已经把无辜的人处死了，那对于误判该怎么办？

A You'd only use capital punishment if you were absolutely sure that you'd convicted the right person.
只有在你绝对确定定罪的人没错时，你才会动用死刑。

B But, there've been many cases of wrongful conviction where people have been imprisoned for many years. The authorities were sure at the time, but later it was shown that the evidence was unreliable. In some cases, it'd been fabricated by the police.
但是，有很多冤案，人们被关押了很多年。当局在当时很确定，但后来证明证据并不可靠。在有些案件里，证据是警方捏造的。

A Well, no system of justice can be perfect, but surely there's a good case for longer prison sentences to deter serious crime.
嗯，没有哪套司法制度是完美的，但延长刑期以遏制严重犯罪，肯定还是有充分理由的。

- B I doubt whether they could act as an effective deterrent while the detection rate is so low. The best way to prevent crime is to convince people who commit it that they're going to be caught. It doesn't make sense to divert all your resources into the prison system.
在破案率这么低的情况下，我怀疑它们能否起到有效的威慑作用。预防犯罪最好的办法，是让犯罪的人相信他们会被抓到。把你所有的资源都投入监狱系统是没有意义的。
- A But if you detect more crimes, you'll still need prisons. In my reckoning, if we could lock up more juvenile criminals, they'd learn that they couldn't get away with it. Soft sentences will merely encourage them to do it again.
但如果你侦破更多案件，你还是需要监狱。依我看，如果我们能关押更多的少年罪犯，他们就会明白自己没法逃脱惩罚。轻判只会纵容他们再犯。
- B Yes, but remember that prisons are often schools for criminals. To remove crime from society, you really have to tackle its causes.
是的，但别忘了监狱往往是罪犯的学校。要从社会中消除犯罪，你真的必须从根源上着手。
- A Well, if I were president, I would impose tougher laws and punishment. I would have a peaceful society based on fear of punishment, not consciousness of doing the right thing.
嗯，如果我是总统，我会施行更严厉的法律和惩罚。我会建立一个基于对惩罚的恐惧、而非基于做正确之事的自觉的太平社会。
- B You sound like a dictator!
你听起来像个独裁者！
- A Well if it works, why not?
嗯，如果管用，何乐而不为呢？

重点词汇 / Key Vocabulary

death penalty	短语	处以死亡的刑罚，死刑
prison sentence	名词（复数）	把罪犯关押在监狱的时长，刑期
juvenile offender	名词（复数）	未成年的罪犯，少年犯
Draconian	形容词	非常严酷苛刻的
miscarriage of justice	短语	不公正的司法裁决，误判

capital punishment	短语	处以死亡的刑罚，死刑
fabricate	动词	编造某事以欺骗他人，捏造
deterrent	名词（单数）	阻止人们做某事的东西，威慑物
divert	动词	把资源从一处调往另一处，转移
dictator	名词（单数）	以绝对权力进行统治的人，独裁者

补充词汇 / Supplementary Vocabulary

diversion	名词（单数）	改变某事物方向或用途的行为，转移
authoritarian	形容词	要求人们服从规章或法律的，专制的
divisive topic	短语	引发分歧、使人分裂成不同群体的议题，有争议的话题
recidivist	名词（单数）	被抓获惩罚后仍继续犯罪的人，惯犯
rehabilitate	动词	教导（狱中罪犯）过上正常而有益的生活，使改过自新